Warm-up / The bicycle rack proposal

Find the claim behind the facts

Name: _____ Date: _____

Suggested lesson time: 15 minutes. Work individually, then compare when invited.

Useful words

Claim: A statement someone asks an audience to accept. In these activities, the main claim is a proposed action.

Evidence: Information offered to support a claim.

Background: Context that helps describe the situation but is not itself offered as the main support.

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: A student says, 'Six bicycles were left against classroom walls today because the rack was full. The school should add another bicycle rack.'

Produce: Write two labelled sentences: one for the proposed action and one for its supporting reason.

Your steps

1. Copy the action the student wants the school to take.

2. Copy the fact offered to support that action.

Before you finish: Does your proposed action say what the school should do, while your reason describes what happened?

Your response

Main activity / The library's later closing time

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: A student writes, 'Our library closes at 5 p.m. During a four-week trial of closing at 7 p.m., weekly visits rose from 400 to 460. The council should keep the later closing time.'

Produce: Write three labelled statements (claim, evidence, background) and one sentence explaining your labels.

Your steps

1. Copy the main claim: the proposal the writer wants the council to accept.

2. Copy the supporting evidence and label the remaining sentence as background.

3. Write one sentence explaining why the visit count is not itself the main claim.

Before you finish: Have you separated the proposed action from the fact used to support it? Do not add 'always' or claim that the trial proves the policy works everywhere.

Your response

Exit ticket / The community garden proposal

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: A resident writes, 'The community garden opened in 2019. All 20 planting plots are in use, and 12 residents are waiting for a plot. The council should create ten more plots.'

Produce: Write the claim, evidence, and background with labels; add one sentence explaining how the evidence relates to the claim.

Your steps

1. Copy the proposed action exactly, including the number of additional plots.

2. Identify the fact offered in support and the fact supplying background.

3. Explain why the demand for plots is evidence for the proposal rather than the proposal itself.

Before you finish: Have you kept the proposal at ten more plots and avoided adding a guarantee that everyone will receive one?

Your response